

SKOAR! Reviews

PS3 fans rejoice Killzone 3 is here. Check out what we have to say.

NFS Hot Pursuit

We tell you if the 'Race or Chase' is really worth all the hype.



Promises to be a wacky fun-fest of the highest order

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Let me get this out right away. Fighting games and I just don't get along very well. I realized this a long time ago while playing the Mortal Kombat series in DOS. I could've blamed it on the PC's unintuitive controls, but I'd be fooling myself, because I faced equally dismal results while playing Street Fighter II in the neighbourhood's seedy video game parlour. Cut to the recent past, and fate once again brought me into contact with my nemesis through Dead or Alive 4 for the X360. I thought I was finally doing well at a fighting game, until a non-gamer colleague came along, challenged me to a versus match, and proceeded to beat me into submission simply by pressing as many

buttons as quickly as possible. So much for second chances.

Third time lucky?

Considering the above, I should be the last person to be tasked with reviewing a fighting game, but destiny ordained that I was told about the MARVEL VS. CAPCOM 3 (MVC3) preview code at Milestone's office when I went there for the Killzone 3 preview. Not wanting to pass up the chance of making some extra money, I agreed immediately and set to work.

I have to admit, as far as concepts go, the MVC series ranks right at the top of the fighting genre. Most other games have invented characters based on a single theme who then might or might not capture the public's fancy, but you just cannot go wrong with

taking established characters. After all, who wouldn't want to see Spider-Man's butt kicked outta the arena by the likes of Ryu? It is for this reason that games like MVC3 and Super Smash Bros are pure genius when it comes to concepts.

It is therefore surprising to know that it took ten long years for Capcom to follow up the success of MVC2. The good news is that in this period of time, several new characters have been added to both marques, thus presenting a wider choice of fighters. The developers have taken full advantage of this and picked some rather creative, if unconventional players.

The best example of this selection is Amaterasu, from Okami. That's right, you can now pit a wolf

(albeit a magical one) against your hero or villain of choice! Another spectacular pick is Sir Arthur the midget knight from the classic Ghosts N Goblins. On the Marvel side of things, there's M.O.D.O.K., aka Mental Organism Designed Only for Killing, who (or which) is essentially a giant pumpkin-shaped head fitted on a floating platform. In other words, American retardedness meets Jap craziness. Thankfully, this is actually a good thing.

Granted, this variety makes for some rather challenging gameplay mechanics. Both Ammy and Arthur, being of non-standard sizes, make for difficult targets to hit. Similarly, M.O.D.O.K. has the ability to stay afloat high up in the air, out of reach of his opponent's standard attacks. However, the diverse strategies that can now be employed depending on your choice of heroes can only lead to interesting results, and this unusual array of fighters is a strong plus for the game. More importantly, it shows that MVC doesn't take itself too seriously, a prerequisite for having fun in any game.

Triple tag mayhem

The preview was a barebones build that put me straight into the action. No intro movie or menu of any sort; just select your characters and fight. The only game mode available was MVC's traditional triple-tag team match against the CPU, with almost the full roster of players that the final release will have.

Before I chose my warriors though, I had to select between

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